

Dhāraṇī of the Noble Avalokiteśvara

Āryāvalokiteśvaradhāraṇī · Toh 717 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་སྐྱ་རས་གཟགིས་དབང་ཡུ་ག་གི་ཟུམ།

Toh 717 in the Kangyur is a short dhāraṇī text associated with the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, known in Sanskrit as Avalokiteśvara and in Tibetan as Spyan ras gzigs dbang phyug. The text consists primarily of a mantra formula invoking qualities of memory, radiance, and purification, opening with homage to the Three Jewels and to Avalokiteśvara as the great bodhisattva and Lord of Vision. As is characteristic of dhāraṇī literature, its contents are largely encoded in a string of sacred syllables intended for recitation and ritual use rather than doctrinal exposition. It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur, a broad canonical collection of such protective and efficacious formulae connected to major bodhisattvas and buddhas of the Mahāyāna tradition.

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the great bodhisattva, the noble Avalokiteśvara, Lord of Vision.

Thus it is: smṛti mati mati, tejo vidyā huru me hara huru kṛṣṇa huru me svāhā. Śuddha dkar —

Translator's Notes

- The passage ends abruptly mid-phrase with "Śuddha dkar," indicating the provided text is incomplete. The bulk of the passage after the homages is a dhāraṇī in transliterated Sanskrit preserved in Tibetan orthography; such dhāraṇī syllables are rendered phonetically by convention and are not translated semantically. The Sanskrit reconstruction follows standard Tibetan transliteration conventions for this type of liturgical material.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly

proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.
May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.